



## Civic Meeting Report

# Muncie Sanitary District Meeting October 2nd 2024

| Meeting Metadata | Details                                                                                               |
|------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Video Recording  | <a href="https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=MNZv1HibI4o">https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=MNZv1HibI4o</a> |
| Publication Date | 2024-10-03T04:12:58Z                                                                                  |
| Target Category  | muncie_city                                                                                           |

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## Muncie Sanitary District: Board of Sanitary Commissioners Meeting Summary

**Meeting Date:** October 2, 2024

**Body:** Board of Sanitary Commissioners, Muncie Sanitary District

### 1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

- **Session Type & Topic:** 00:00:24 Public Hearing on Resolution 2024-14 (Schedule of Sewage Rates).
- **Summary of Discussion:** The board opened the statutory public hearing regarding the proposed schedule of sewage rates, which was initially introduced at the regular board meeting two weeks prior. The presiding officer opened the floor for public comment on the rate schedule. Seeing no public interest or testimony, a motion to adjourn/close the public hearing was made by Aaron and seconded by Adam, passing by voice vote. The board immediately transitioned into the regular session.

## 2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

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- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The regular meeting of the Board of Sanitary Commissioners for the Muncie Sanitary District was called to order on October 2, 2024.
  - **Attendance:** All five commissioners were present (no excused absences). The presiding officer noted full attendance.
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## 3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

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- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance, led by the presiding officer.
  - **Approval of Minutes:** 00:03:10 The board considered the minutes from the September 18th board meeting. A motion to approve as submitted was made by Adam, seconded by David, and approved by voice vote.
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## 4. Substantive Business & Board Action

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- 00:03:40 **Consideration of Register of Claims**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board President / Administration.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** The board reviewed claims totaling \$66,730.70. Highlights included East Central recycling costs (\$7,595) for household disposal, street departments, and parks, as well as a clarification that "Farm & Fleet" on the claims register refers to the recently renamed Greensfork location (changed about a month prior).
  - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (Motion by Tim, Second by Adam).
- 00:08:04 **Resolution 2024-14: Schedule of Sewage Rates (Old Business)**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Rick Conrad, District Administrator / Baker Tilly (Cost of Service Study).
  - **Deliberation Summary:** The board formally considered the 4-year sewage rate schedule. Commissioner Clark expressed a preference for a 2-year look due to interest rate volatility and future funding unknowns, though acknowledged the necessity of rate adjustments. Other commissioners and the administrator noted that the 4-year timeline is necessary to secure market confidence for upcoming bond sales and bond anticipation notes (BANs), to address post-2019 inflation, and to fund mandated EPA/IDEM combined sewer overflow (CSO) separation projects required by 2030. The study also restructured minimum fees into a base rate to fairly distribute fixed costs across residential, commercial, institutional, and industrial classes.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None (aside from the prior public hearing).
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved 4-1 (Motion by Board President, Second by David).
- **00:19:09 Release of Retainage to Bowen Engineering (New Business)**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Rick Conrad, District Administrator.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Request to release \$2,925 in escrowed retainage (5% standard) following substantial completion and punch-list sign-offs for stormwater projects in Indian village, North View storm sewer, and Leick Avenue.
  - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (Motion by David, Second by Aaron).
- **00:21:17 Resolution 2024-15: Establishing Procedures and Penalties for Ordinance Violations**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Rick Conrad, District Administrator / Legal Counsel.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Resolution establishes enforcement mechanisms and graduated penalties for violations of City Code Chapter 52 (litter and waste), specifically targeting chronic trash/totter cleanup issues on sanitation days. Penalties include a 10-day cleanup warning, a \$75 fine after 15 days, \$150 after a month, and \$300 plus clean-up costs thereafter. Fines will return to the sanitation and recycling department. The board emphasized that staff must use discretion.
  - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (Motion by Tim, Second by Aaron).
- **00:25:23 Approval of Sale of 701 East 23rd Street Property**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Rick Conrad, District Administrator.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** The district purchased the property 10 years ago for \$1 for a long-term control plan project that is no longer needed. The property features historical environmental constraints and was appraised at approximately \$9,000. Publicly posted for bids in July, the district received a single bid of \$500 from adjacent property owner Randy Justice. Selling the property returns it to local tax rolls.
  - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (Motion by Adam, Second by David).

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## 5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

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*No members of the public stepped forward to speak during the general public comment periods at the timestamps **00:01:29** and **00:02:56**.*

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## 6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

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- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
  - **District Administrator Update (00:05:13):** Rick Conrad reported road closures at C Street near Burlington for sewer work (ending by week's end) and traffic control at Burlington and May for drainage work. CSO 13 will soon be sealed/filled per Army Corps requirements, reducing active active CSOs from 10 down to 9 (down from 18 in 2010). Leaf pickup programs are anticipated to begin in approximately two weeks, with public notice via social media. Residents were urged to keep storm drains clear of leaves to prevent localized flooding.
  - **Board Topics (00:28:40):** Commissioner Adam noted upcoming leaf season guidance from sanitation. The Board President discussed INDOT's Highway 32 project updates, noting that the roundabout at Ohio Street has been canceled (leaving roundabouts planned only at Hackley and Madison), with construction tentatively timed for after school lets out in 2027 and requiring no sanitary district work.
  - **Next Meeting:** Scheduled for Wednesday, October 16, 2024, at City Hall Auditorium.
- **Adjournment:** Official adjournment via voice vote following a motion by Adam and a second by David 00:30:44.

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